

Can AI be "good" and sustainable?

Posted by u/Maleficent_Stick6762 • 0 points • 22 comments

I don't really know much about AI and how datacenters and stuff work, but I do know that these datacenters consume a lot of resources and are the cause for pollution and put neighbourhoods near them in danger. I used to use AI a lot, but I've pretty much completely been avoiding it and instead have been searching for answers to specific questions here, on Reddit. And I also get how AI can steal jobs and create cheap art, I myself am an animator, and although I'm still learning, it's a bummer to see how AI can create an animation from just a few lines of text, while actual artists put years into their work. But, I see how AI can be used for things that may be considered "good" too, like idk, surveillance for endangered animals (and I believe it is already), I believe to help in the field of de-extinction or similar stuff (or so I've heard), and much more honestly. So how can AI as a whole be made to be more regulated, sustainable to the environment, beneficial to development and "good"? And how could this AI maybe replace AIs like ChatGPT to be the standard for AI? I'd like to hear your guys' thoughts about this, even though it might've been asked millions of times before.

Comments

u/see-more_options • 1 points • 2026-01-18 09:23 UTC

Spending more time looking for answers on a website/app hosted in a data center somewhere, huh. Instead of getting your answers quickly and efficiently, this spending less energy/"resources" and generating less "pollution". To save the planet.

Interesting choice, comrade.

u/Nightsheade • 1 points • 2026-01-17 19:35 UTC

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Is wildlife surveillance not something people can put years of work into and which AI can potentially steal jobs from? Why is AI "good" in this case?

u/OhTheHueManatee • 1 points • 2026-01-17 19:17 UTC

People like to look at the resources data center uses and say it's all AI when it does more than just AI. That being said we should not be allowing data centers to pollute neighborhoods or the environment. Unfortunately the current administration believes that pollution is not a concern so it'll likely keep happening. I think it overall can be sustainable but the people who create it are not going to volunteer to do that.

u/ShagaONhan • 5 points • 2026-01-17 18:44 UTC

We have optimized models that run on potatoes now, to the point people complaining about AI art are using more datacenter energy whining about it.

And if you are a skilled animator your are going to do a way better job with a good tool than a random. If someone decide to tie their hands because they have some religious restrictions on using certain tools they can't really ask the others to do the same to be fair.

u/Maleficent_Stick6762 • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:48 UTC

I'm a learning animator as I said, so not good enough to get a job, and animation is more of a hobby for me rather than something I want to pursue. That aside though, I didn't really understand what you mean in the last part. Did you mean that like AI can be used in artistic processes? If so how? I genuinely didn't understand and don't want to come off as sarcastic or rude in some way, I just want to understand all the viewpoints to this.

u/ShagaONhan • 3 points • 2026-01-17 19:05 UTC

AI is not magical, people that only scratch the surface don't see all the possibilities and complexities. The issue is to really know that you need to actually practice it, and the people that are against it will never do, and will still be stuck at all AI is midjourney generation.

u/Zorothegallade • 6 points • 2026-01-17 18:38 UTC

Fact is, AI increased the load on datacenters, but their energy and water consumption are ultimately a blip in the radar in the overall consumption charts. Hell, the increase in demand from industry and agriculture alone every year has more of an impact than the advent of AI models had.

u/Maleficent_Stick6762 • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:42 UTC

I've heard about that too, I'm not that informed on all these stats or specifications, which is why I was asking for different viewpoints. But wouldn't you say AI could still be more sustainable? Because they still do consume a lot of natural resources. But yeah, the same thing should be said for every other industry that's harmful to the environment and the people.

u/Zorothegallade • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:51 UTC

Of course, it can always improve. Right now everyone is in a mad turf rush to secure as many customers as possible and efficiency is a secondary concern because investments just keep getting pumped into the system.

When, hopefully, the bubble will pop and AI will no longer be the money-printing machine it's being treated as by the corpos, they will have to focus on making it more energy-efficient to preserve their revenue.

u/Maleficent_Stick6762 • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:54 UTC

Ah alright, got it. Yeah that's a fair point.

u/NoWin3930 • -3 points • 2026-01-17 18:37 UTC

if by good and sustainable you mean harmful to the trans community

u/Maleficent_Stick6762 • 2 points • 2026-01-17 18:44 UTC

I don't know what you mean by that but probably not. Sustainable in terms of good for the planet and its inhabitants.

u/NoWin3930 • -1 points • 2026-01-17 18:46 UTC

got it i wasnt sure what u meant exactly

u/Maleficent_Stick6762 • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:49 UTC

ah no problem happens

u/EtherKitty • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:42 UTC

If by harmful to the trans community, you mean in the same way screwdrivers can kill trans people, sure. It's a tool, reliant on its operator.

u/NoWin3930 • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:43 UTC

But transphobia is written into the foundation of the technology

u/EtherKitty • 2 points • 2026-01-17 18:51 UTC

No it's not. Information is. Even the dread musks ai rejects transphobia. Elon has tried to do that but it keeps reverting. Transphobic people can manage to do transphobic stuff with it, but again, you could physically harm a trans person with a screwdriver. That doesn't make screwdrivers transphobic.

u/NoWin3930 • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:59 UTC

Elon musk is trans

u/EtherKitty • 1 points • 2026-01-17 19:22 UTC

No, his daughter is. -_-

u/Elegant-Pie6486 • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:48 UTC

No.

u/DaylightDarkle • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:40 UTC

No one meant that.

u/NoWin3930 • 1 points • 2026-01-17 18:42 UTC

NVM i misunderstood the post